



APPLICATION FOR GROUP DIRECTOR, TECHNOLOGY OPERATIONS - GLOBAL GOVERNANCE DIGITAL STRATEGY

July 16, 2026
Hiring Committee
Global Governance Digital Strategy
Walmart Inc. | Bentonville, Arkansas

Responsible speed needs an operating system.

Walmart is expanding AI across customer experiences, associate work, operations, and partner ecosystems. That acceleration creates a difficult leadership problem: governance must protect legal, ethical, privacy, and security obligations without becoming a sequence of disconnected reviews that slows learning and obscures value.

I would approach the Group Director role by making the portfolio scannable. Every AI initiative should carry an explicit decision contract: the business outcome, legal basis, risk and harm profile, data boundaries, human authority, operating ownership, and evidence required to fund, release, scale, hold, or stop. This creates a common operating language across Global Governance, Technology, Finance, and business teams while preserving the substantive authority of Legal, Compliance, Ethics, Investigations, and Security.

My career has prepared me for that intersection. At Vape-Jet, I lead AI-first operating transformation across production, quality, purchasing, support, engineering issue flow, ERP, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows. Through DudeWorth, I design AI-readiness and agentic workflow patterns that connect value, feasibility, human judgment, escalation, evaluation, governance, and adoption. At Amazon, I built mechanisms in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually. Earlier, at Compunetics, I led engineering, manufacturing, quality, and high-reliability technical programs serving demanding stakeholders including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD.

I am not proposing to substitute an operations framework for legal or compliance judgment. I am proposing to make that judgment easier to apply consistently, easier to instrument, and easier to connect to portfolio economics and adoption. The independent candidate vision at <https://russelldudek.github.io/Walmart/> demonstrates this approach through a Scannable AI Contract, executive scorecard, 120-day entry plan, and practical AI Portfolio Review.

My first 120 days would begin by mapping decision rights, active initiatives, operating friction, risk tiers, and the work each governance function is protecting. From there, I would co-design the minimum portfolio contract, test it on two contrasting use cases, and establish an executive review that produces real funding, release, hold, and stop decisions rather than additional status reporting.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss which governance decisions Walmart most needs to accelerate, which controls can become reusable capabilities, and what evidence should determine the next dollar of AI investment.

Carpe diem,
Russell Dudek